

The Ethical Hacker's Command Handbook

Chapter 3 – Part 5: Exploit Validation & Research Workflow

Identify → Research → Verify → Document

Learning Objectives

Learn how to validate exploit applicability by comparing software versions, reviewing CVEs, consulting vendor advisories, evaluating exploit requirements, and documenting findings.

Why Validation Matters

A Searchsploit result is not proof that a system is vulnerable. Always verify the software version, patch level, platform, and exploit requirements.

Compare Versions

Match the product, major version, minor version, and patch version identified during enumeration with the exploit documentation.

Review CVEs

Use CVE references to understand affected versions, severity, references, and available mitigations.

Vendor Advisories

Consult official vendor documentation to confirm affected versions, patches, fixes, and workarounds.

Evaluate Requirements

Determine whether authentication, configuration, operating system, or other prerequisites are required.

Document Findings

Record evidence, software version, exploit reference, verification status, and recommendations.

Validation Workflow

Nmap → Identify Product → Identify Version → Searchsploit → Review Exploit → Review CVE → Vendor Advisory → Evaluate Requirements → Document Findings

Step	Purpose
Nmap	Identify software and version
Searchsploit	Locate public exploit references

CVE	Research vulnerability details
Vendor Advisory	Confirm affected versions and fixes
Documentation	Record evidence and conclusions

Practice Questions

1. Why isn't a Searchsploit result enough to confirm a vulnerability?
2. Why should vendor advisories be reviewed?
3. What exploit requirements should be checked?
4. What should a professional report include?
5. Why is exploit validation important?